



- The best way to test a voice-over is to read it **out loud**. If the narrator **runs out of breath**, or gets **confused**, the script needs to be **rewritten**.

On average, a narrator can read **180 words** out loud **per minute**.

Dramatic scripts

A dramatic script tells a story. However, unlike a written narrative, a script will be performed. Dramatic scripts can be for the theater, television, radio, or film. Each type has slightly different conventions, but they have some common features.

Directions

A script should include directions that tell everyone involved what to do. Directions indicate when actors should enter and exit, and in what tone they should perform a line. Other directions relate to lighting, sound effects, or camera shots, such as close-ups.

PROTEST

The title of the piece goes at the top.

Scene A park that is going to be demolished to make way for a shopping center. There are protest chants.

The setting and the characters involved in the scene are listed at the top.

Characters

MEADOW An environmental activist
DETECTIVE STUBBS A police officer

Directions show when characters enter and exit the scene. They should be in parentheses.

(MEADOW starts to climb a tree.)
(Enter DETECTIVE STUBBS.)

Directions also include adverbs that tell actors how to perform their lines.

DETECTIVE STUBBS:

What do you think you're doing?

MEADOW: (angrily)

Saving our trees!

DETECTIVE STUBBS:

Get down immediately!

(MEADOW laughs and scrambles to the top of the tree.)

DETECTIVE STUBBS:

Hey you, come back!

Dialogue

The dialogue refers to the conversation between characters. In a play, the plot is controlled by the dialogue and action, so the words need to tell the audience what is happening. The speech also needs to be convincing, so it should reflect the age, nationality, personality, and mood of each character.